

GREAT PICTURE COMING

"Birth of a Nation" Will Show at Shively Opera House Next Week

Many a town has gotten the contemptuous title of a "bad show town" simply because its people were not easily gulled into taking for granted every Jim Crow attraction that took a notion to play there. Such places usually prove to be the very best show towns when you offer them the goods, say those behind the famous Griffith's "Birth of a Nation."

It is one of the "ironies of fate" that this superb and widely discussed attraction proves every town it strikes a first class show town. The city of Milwaukee, for instance, has just lately been considered a "weak stand" for the customary dramatic and musical organizations traveling, yet Griffith's production played there at the leading opera house to capacity business, night and day, for two solid months, and in the heated "off" summer season, too.

In the course of time it was not able that the poorest week's business of the entire engagement was the first week, which proves that, while people were slow to take hold until they were convinced it was all it was expected to be, they flocked there after they heard of its merits.

Watch the marvel prove Oregon City a great show town on the occasion of its coming engagement at the Shively Opera house, December 14-15.

Every town is willing to patronize the genuine article, but many do not "fall" easily for the snide.

From coast to coast it is a national holiday when this production appears and the people turn out as if Abraham Lincoln himself were scheduled to speak at the theatre. Accompanying this great spectacle is the celebrated symphony orchestra, which renders a special three hour score—a veritable treat in itself. Seats may be reserved at Jones' drug store on Saturday, December 9. Matinee daily

at 2:45, prices 25 and 50 cents. Nights at 8:15, prices 50c, 75c and \$1.00.

Obituaries

Fred Bullard

Fred Bullard, for 34 years a resident of Oregon City and a native of Germany, where he was born 80 years ago, died at his home at Mountain View Monday morning. The funeral was held Wednesday morning at 11 and interment was in Mountain View cemetery. Those who survive Mr. Bullard are his widow, Mrs. Charlotte Bullard; two daughters, Mrs. Richard Schoenborn and Mrs. J. D. Baker, of Oregon City, and three sons, Frank and Chris, of this city, and Robert, of Schuebel.

Joseph L. Mumpower

Joseph L. Mumpower, who had been a well-known and popular resident of Stone for 34 years, died at a Salem hospital on Sunday, aged 80 years. Interment was in the Logan cemetery, following funeral services conducted at the Stone church on Tuesday. Mr. Mumpower was a native of Virginia and had been living at Stone since he came to Oregon in 1882. He is survived by a daughter, Mrs. John Hattan of Redland, and three sons, W. E. Mumpower of Stone, L. D. Mumpower of Gladstone and Grant Mumpower of Stone.

Teachers' Examination

J. A. Churchill, state superintendent of public instruction, has set December 20 to 23 inclusive as the dates for the annual examination of applicants for state teachers' certificates. The tests will be conducted under the direction of J. E. Calavan, county school superintendent, and will be held at the Masonic building.

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CONGRESSIONAL COMMITTEE BEGINS RAILWAY INQUIRY

Proposed by President to Better Condition of Carriers.

MAY CHANGE PRESENT SYSTEM

Officials of Roads Prepared to Advocate Federal Incorporation, Supervision of Securities and Extension of Authority of Interstate Commerce Commission.

Washington, Nov. 20.—Ten members of Congress, five Senators and five members of the House of Representatives, began here today an inquiry into the subject of public control and supervision of railroads that may lead to the revolutionizing of the whole scheme of governmental regulation of the country's transportation lines. Incidentally the committee is to look into the question of government ownership of railroads, telephone and telegraph lines and express companies.

The members of the committee which will conduct this important investigation are Senator Newlands of Nevada, chairman; Senators Robinson of Arkansas, Underwood of Alabama, Cummins of Iowa and Brandegee of Connecticut, and Representatives Adamson of Georgia, Sims of Tennessee, Cullop of Indiana, Esch of Wisconsin and Hamilton of Michigan. The inquiry was recommended by President Wilson in his message to Congress in December of last year. He described as its purpose to determine what could be done "for bettering the conditions under which the railroads are operated and for making them more useful servants of the country as a whole."

Prominent Men as Witnesses.

In order to obtain the views of all interests affected by the operations of the transportation lines the committee has invited prominent shippers, bankers, representatives of commercial organizations, railway executives, economists and others to appear before them.

The first to be heard are railroad commissioners of various states who began their evidence today. Their testimony is directed chiefly to opposing any enlargement of the federal authority over commerce that would detract from the powers now exercised by state bodies. They will be followed shortly by officials of railway labor organizations who are expected to register their opposition to the increase of governmental authority over wages and conditions of labor.

Chief interest in the hearings centers in the proposals that will be put forward by representatives of the railroads. It is reported that they will advocate an extension of federal authority over rates and securities to the practical exclusion of state control of these matters. It is understood also that they will go on record in favor of federal incorporation of all railroad lines.

Legislative Program of Railroads.

From an authoritative source is obtained the following outline of the legislative program which the railroads will ask the committee to consider in its investigation: They will endeavor to demonstrate to the commission that one of the principal defects in the present system of railroad regulation is the lack of coordination resulting from the simultaneous and conflicting regulation by the federal government and by the 48 states. They will, therefore, ask that entire governmental control of the rates and practices of interstate carriers, except purely local matters, be placed in the hands of a federal body so that interstate traffic may be regulated without reference to state lines, leaving to the state commissions jurisdiction only over local matters and local public utilities. As a part of this plan, a compulsory system of federal incorporation is to be recommended, accompanied by federal supervision of railroad stock and bond issues.

A reorganization of the Interstate Commerce Commission will be asked, in order to enable the commission properly to exercise its increased powers. It is also proposed that the preparation and prosecution of cases against the railroads shall be delegated to some other agency of the government, possibly the Department of Justice, so that the commission may devote its energies to its administrative functions.

With the commission thus relieved of some of its present duties and equipped to handle its business more promptly, the railroads will urge that the period during which the commission may now suspend proposed increases in rates be reduced from ten months to 60 days, with provision for reparation to be paid to the shippers if the advance shall be declared unreasonable.

They will also ask that the commission be given the power to prescribe minimum as well as maximum rates so that in meeting complaints of discrimination the commission may order the advance of a rate which it considers too low.

One of the most important recommendations for which the railroads will ask favorable consideration is that the commission be specifically authorized to take into account in rate regulation the effect of rates upon total earnings in the light of expenses.

While the Newlands Committee is required, under the resolution creating it, to submit a report by January 2 next, it is not anticipated that the Committee will have come anywhere near completing its labors then.

May Change Postal Rates

The ways are now being greased for the launching of the movement for the readjustment of postal rates in the next session of congress. This problem was to have been taken up in the last session but had to be deferred on account of the consideration required by railway mail pay. Since this has been disposed of the committees are prepared to take up the matter of placing the various postal rates on a more equitable basis.

A zone system of rates for second class matter is being prominently urged to take the place of the present

SCHOOLS VERSUS ROADS

Writer Praises Courier Thought and Decries Neglect of Rural Schools

Mulino, Oregon, Nov. 27, 1916.

Editor Courier:

An article which appeared in a recent edition of your paper, regarding the school funds, brings up before the people a question which is certainly worthy of our consideration. In every community we find the people discussing the betterment of their roads, donating labor and voting special taxes that they may have the best of roads. This is all very well, but—in how many of these communities do we hear these same people discussing the betterment of their schools, donating labor and voting special taxes that they may have the best school? No, so long as Johnny and Mary hike off to school some time before noon and get back in time to get in the wood, etc., everything is all right with the school. It matters not whether they are spending their days in a poorly lighted, heated and ventilated school room with no desks or blackboards, in fact half of them do not even go down to the school to see them trying to play One Old Cat in a yard filled with stumps. Why don't they donate a few days clearing the stumps out of their school yard?

We have a good example of such men right here in Clackamas county. He happens to be the possessor of a few dollars, which he has hoarded together, and, unfortunately, he has now arrived to that state where he cannot see beyond the almighty dollar. He has not taken any interest in school meetings in his district for several years, but this year when he learned that his neighbors were doing their best to get a three-mill tax passed for the purpose of securing a new stove, etc., removing a few of the stumps from the yard and continuing the six-month term two months, he woke up and became the greatest school enthusiast in the district. With his family and employees he was "Johnny-on-the-spot," and through his influence the tax was killed.

Mr. Tight Waddo's children are now educated, that is, they do not go to school any more, consequently he does not "feel like educating his neighbors' children," not liking to break away from a few of his pickled eagles, but he was all smiles when the county gave \$180 and these same neighbors donated work to cut down a hill above his mill so that the teamsters could get access to his mill. Oh! yes! this was all very nice because it was going to add a few more dollars to his pile, but when it came to helping these same neighbors better the condition of their children's school, Mr. Tight Waddo could not be seen for the smoke.

Build the roads—we need them; but let's not forget that our boys and girls must go to school. And the next time there are any hills to be cut down we will all be there with our teams and hired men.

Truly yours,

One Who Knows.

K. E. D. CLUB LOSES

St. Helens High School Team Blights Hopes of Local Youths

The K. E. D. club football team of this city met the fast St. Helens high school eleven there on Thursday and was defeated by a score of 28 to 12. At the end of the first half the score stood 12 to 0 in favor of the K. E. D. boys, but the forward passing ability of the opponent was too much for them in the second period. The K. E. D.'s were handicapped by the loss of their star end, Gordon Fauley. Prof. John Mason and Coach Harding accompanied the team, which lined up as follows for the fray: Rankins, right end; Russell Fauley, right guard; L. Vierhus, center; Barry, left guard; Sturgis, left tackle; Barry, left end; Art King, right half; MacDonald, fullback; Steincamp, left half, and C. Vierhus, quarter.

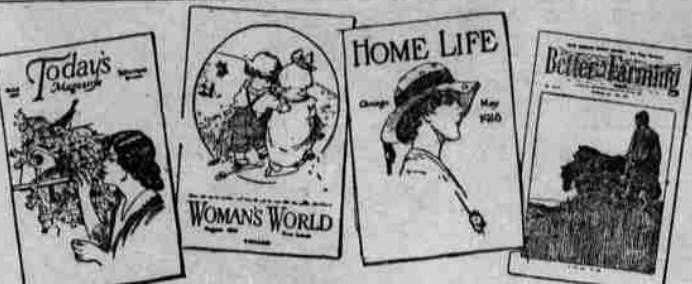
The Courier—\$1.00 per year.

ent flat rate which was adopted nearly forty years ago. The present rate has for some time been regarded as a discrimination against the newspapers in favor of the great national magazines. Like the parcel post the proposed zone rates would be based on the length of the haul. The postal committees have been besieged by petitions bearing millions of names and several hundred thousand letters from individuals urging a readjustment of postal rates with a view of making possible one cent letter postage. A survey of the situation indicates that sufficient changes will be made in the various rates to permit the granting of a one cent rate on local delivery letters in the next session of congress. Congressman McArthur of Oregon takes the stand that "the cost of transporting a letter should have something to do with the postage rate, and there is no valid reason why more than one cent should be charged for local deliveries. If my bill becomes a law it will have a great tendency to stimulate business."

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The Picture Tells The Story

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Cost is going down

Though it has been said times without number, it is always worth retelling that the cost of electric service keeps coming down while everything else is going up. Food, shelter, clothing, luxuries—all cost more than they did a few years ago and none of them have bettered in quality. Today the public utility companies are giving much better service and are charging less for it than a few years ago. Today you can ride to your heart's content in a trolley car for a nickel. The new EDISON MAZDA LAMPS give you THREE TIMES THE LIGHT for the same amount of electric current consumption as the old lamps.

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